ALLIANCE FOR CANCERCARE EQUITY

2023 ANNUAL REPORT

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Message From the President & CEO

Dear Supporters, Partners, and Friends,

The year 2023 stands as a defining milestone in the journey of Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE). It was a year of establishment, growth, and deep commitment to our mission of ensuring equitable access to cancer care for those in need.

One of our most significant achievements was receiving official charitable status from the Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) on February 13, 2023. This milestone not only validated the work we have been doing but also positioned ACCE to grow, build trust, and expand our reach.

Throughout the year, we continued to respond to the urgent needs of cancer patients, particularly those facing financial hardship. Despite operating with limited resources, we supported patients across Ghana and Canada, helping them access critical treatments such as chemotherapy and radiotherapy.

At the same time, 2023 highlighted the reality of our limitations. We were not able to meet every request for support, and difficult decisions had to be made to prioritize patients with the most urgent needs. These moments reinforced the importance of building a stronger and more sustainable organization.

We are grateful to our donors, board members, and volunteers whose commitment made this work possible. As we move forward, we remain focused on strengthening our capacity so that we can serve more patients and create lasting impact.

Dr Ernest Osei

Founder, President & CEO

Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE)

Our Vision:

No cancer patient is denied high-quality cancer care based on race, religion or a family's ability to pay.

Our Mission:

To advance equity in the cancer care continuum from prevention to survivorship and to serve patients battling cancer and their families with the financial, emotional and educational support necessary to cope with the life-threatening illness.

Who We Are

Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE) is a registered charity organization in Canada and Ghana to advance equity in cancer care. We firmly believe that no person should die of cancer because the family cannot afford to pay for their treatment. Moreover, the financial situation of a patient's family should never dictate their chances of surviving a cancer diagnosis. Thus we have taken on a very ambitious cause to pay for the cancer treatment and related cost of patients who are without the financial means to pay for their treatment.

Our Purposes

- To fund the treatment, travel and related costs for patients with cancer who are without the financial means to receive adequate healthcare services, in Canada and Ghana
- To provide medical equipment for the diagnosis and treatment of cancer patients in non-profit community healthcare centers
- To provide cancer patients and their families with access to mutual support groups and related counselling
- To conduct research into the causes, prevention, screening, diagnosis, control, and management of cancer and other diseases, in Canada and Ghana

About Alliance for CancerCare Equity

Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE) is a charitable organization dedicated to addressing disparities in cancer care by supporting underserved individuals who face financial and systemic barriers to treatment.

Our mission is to:

- Provide financial support for cancer treatment
- Improve access to care for vulnerable populations
- Advocate for equitable cancer care systems
- Offer supportive services that address the holistic needs of patients

2023 Program Activities

A. Patient Support and Treatment Access

In 2023, ACCE made significant strides in expanding access to cancer treatment.

Patient Support Highlights

- 18 patients from Ghana were supported in 2023
- Multiple patients supported in Ghana, particularly at:
    - Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital (KATH)
    - Korle Bu Teaching Hospital (KBTH)

Patients received support for:

- Chemotherapy treatments
- Radiotherapy
- Medication and related care

Challenges in Patient Care

- The radiotherapy machine breakdown at treatment centers significantly affected care delivery, leaving many patients reliant on chemotherapy
- Limited funds meant:
    - Some patient requests could not be supported
    - Referrals had to be temporarily paused toward the end of the year
- ACCE adopted a policy to prioritize:
    - Patients unable to begin treatment due to financial constraints
    - Direct payments to hospitals to ensure accountability

B. Systems and Process Improvements

Streamlining Patient Support

- Payment processes for beneficiaries in Ghana were improved to ensure efficiency and accountability
- A policy was introduced requiring:
    - Approval from ACCE for any change in treatment plans
    - Direct coordination with healthcare providers

Financial and Operational Systems

- Discussions were held on adopting accounting software, though the organization continued with its existing system due to cost considerations
- New financial controls and approval processes were implemented to strengthen oversight

C. Organizational Development

Charitable Status and Compliance

- ACCE officially became a registered charity with the CRA in February 2023
- Efforts were made to request a retroactive start date (November 2022), though the official date remained unchanged

Registration with Fundraising Platforms

To expand fundraising reach, ACCE registered with multiple platforms:

- CanadaHelps
- GoFundMe
- PayPal Giving Fund
- Benevity
- Facebook/Instagram fundraising tools

Banking and Financial Infrastructure

- A First Atlantic Bank account was opened in Ghana to facilitate local transactions
- Steps were taken to establish an MTN MoMo account to improve local donation and payment efficiency
- MoneyGram transfers were introduced to address international transfer challenges

D. Fundraising and Resource Mobilization

Fundraising Strategy

ACCE adopted a two-stream fundraising approach:

- Targeted campaigns (seasonal fundraising efforts)
- Ongoing fundraising throughout the year

Fundraiser Recruitment

- Outreach efforts were made via social media to recruit fundraisers
- Initial interest was received from individuals willing to support community fundraising initiatives

Challenges

- Donations showed a downward trend mid-year
- Limited donor base constrained the organization's ability to expand patient support
- External factors, including restrictions on foreign exchange transactions, impacted fund transfers

E. Addressing Operational Challenges

Payment and Transfer Issues

- A Ghana government directive restricting certain forex transactions affected transfers through LemFi
- ACCE adapted by:
  - Switching to MoneyGram for transfers
  - Allowing temporary use of personal accounts (with reimbursement) to ensure timely patient payments

Use of Refunds and Available Funds

- Funds refunded by hospitals were reallocated to support other patients
- Policies were implemented to ensure:
  - Efficient use of available resources
  - Avoidance of idle funds in hospital accounts

2023 Financial Statement

Thanks to all our dedicated donors for your generous support. We want you to know that 100% of every donation goes directly toward covering the cost of treatment for cancer patients. Every dollar you give helps provide critical care, medications, and support services, making a real and immediate difference in the lives of those fighting cancer

ACCE INCOME STATEMENT DECEMBER 31 2023	
Donations (2023 opening balance)	5,602.36
Total Revenue Receipted	18,487.83
Total Donations un-receipted	1,984.88
Total Expenses	-21,805.37
Ending Balance January 4 2023	4,269.70
ACCE BALANCE SHEET DECEMBER 31 2023	
Cash	4,269.70
Equity	4,269.70

Financial Reflection

In 2023:

- Expenditure exceeded donations, reflecting the high demand for patient support
- Administrative costs remained minimal, with the majority of funds directed to treatment
- Financial sustainability emerged as a key priority for future planning

Special Mentions and Thank Yous

To Our Donors

We extend our deepest gratitude to all donors whose contributions made it possible to support cancer patients in critical need. Your generosity continues to change lives.

Special Recognition

A special thank you to the Settor family for their consistent and meaningful support throughout the year.

To Our Board Members

We acknowledge the dedication and leadership of the board, whose commitment guided the organization through a foundational year.

To Our Volunteers and Supporters

Thank you to individuals who supported:

- fundraising initiatives
- patient coordination
- community outreach

To Our Healthcare Partners

We appreciate the collaboration with healthcare providers and institutions in Ghana and Canada who helped facilitate patient care.

Future Goals

Based on the experiences of 2023, ACCE has identified the following priorities:

1. **Strengthen Financial Sustainability**

- Expand donor base
- Increase recurring donations
- Develop structured fundraising campaigns

2. **Expand Patient Support Capacity**

- Increase funding to support more patients
- Reduce the number of unmet patient requests

3. **Improve Operational Efficiency**

- Explore adoption of appropriate accounting tools

- Strengthen financial reporting and tracking systems

4. **Enhance Local Presence in Ghana**

- Strengthen in-country coordination
- Improve payment and logistics systems

5. **Increase Awareness and Outreach**

- Grow social media presence
- Recruit volunteers for communications and fundraising
- Share patient stories to highlight impact

6. **Strengthen Partnerships**

- Build relationships with healthcare institutions
- Explore collaborations with other charities and organizations

Closing Reflections

The year 2023 was a foundational year for ACCE, marked by important milestones, meaningful impact, and valuable lessons.

While challenges remain, particularly in funding and capacity, the progress made this year has laid a strong foundation for the future.

ACCE remains committed to advancing equitable access to cancer care and supporting those who need it most.

Together, we can continue to bring hope, dignity, and care to cancer patients and their families.